



Contemporary · professors at INSEAD.

"Make the competition irrelevant."

THE WHY THAT DROVE THE WORK

Kim and Mauborgne asked why firms exhaust themselves competing in crowded 'red oceans' when they could create uncontested market space instead.

INTELLECTUAL FOUNDATION

Their research across many industries argued that lasting success comes from value innovation — simultaneously raising buyer value and lowering cost — rather than from beating rivals on the same terms.

FRAMEWORKS ANCHORED IN THIS COURSE

They anchor the Blue Ocean Strategy Canvas in Unit 1's opportunity-sensing Slibrary.

HOW THE IDEAS OPERATIONALISE

Blue Ocean operationalises through tools such as the strategy canvas and the eliminate-reduce-raise-create grid, redrawing an industry's value curve.

LIMITATIONS & CRITIQUE

Critics note blue oceans can be hard to identify in advance and are quickly contested once proven; the theory is stronger as a lens than as a repeatable formula.

ENDURING IMPACT

Blue Ocean Strategy became a global bestseller and a standard part of the strategy canon, popularising value innovation and market creation.

ON THE SAME PANEL (UNIT 1)

Russell Ackoff · Giant 1

John Boyd · Giant 2

Clayton Christensen · Giant 3

Jan Carlzon · Giant 4

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Kim, W.C. and Mauborgne, R. (2005) Blue Ocean Strategy. Boston: HBS Press.

Kim, W.C. and Mauborgne, R. (2017) Blue Ocean Shift. New York: Hachette.